dl-prototype cheat sheet

design-led SDD · prototype tier · v0.2.1

/dl-prototype:<skill>
one question at a time

THE LOOP

Request spec, brief → **Clarify** no open ? → **Analyse** fresh agent → **Tasks** tickets → **Build** lead + 2 → **Prove** on target → **Playtest** revise

↺ rule or scope change goes back into the spec and reruns analyze · tuning goes straight in

Two starts. New game: `constitution`. Existing game: `adopt`, then spec the change, not the game; the build beats the document.

EIGHT SKILLS

`constitution`	New game: pillars, platforms, rules
`adopt`	Existing game: start from its docs
`spec`	Full path: write a feature spec
`brief`	Short path: one page, one helper
`clarify`	Work open questions to Ready
`analyze`	Separate agent checks consistency
`tasks`	Job stories, Gherkin, tasks
`playtest`	Turn a session into spec changes

WRITE A RULE

```
F003.claim-once: one gift a day
When      player opens the panel
Provided  not claimed today
Then      button is active
Otherwise shows next-gift time
```

- A stable ID: `F003.short-id`
- Always an **Otherwise**: most bugs live there
- Examples on both sides of the guard
- Tuning values in Parameters, never in rule text

READY GATE

1. Intent, experience, scope in and out
2. Every rule has an example
3. No blocking **?** still Open
4. Special terms in the glossary
5. `analyze` clean on the final state
6. The designer marks it Ready

Done = played on the target, reviewed by someone else, deviations written back.

OPEN QUESTIONS

- Mark it inline: **?** Nothing with a blocking ? is built
- One register row each: `OQ-F001-002`
- Columns: question, owner, blocking, status
- Status: Open · Resolved: answer · Deferred
- Phrase it as a choice, recommended option first
- Business questions go to the owner

WHO DECIDES

Owner	What the game does, scope, word meanings
Designer	Design gaps, playtest conclusions
Producer	Priority, scope, ready and done
Agents	Nothing. They stop and report gaps

GRADUATE TO PRODUCTION WHEN

- A wrong rule costs money or trust (economy, rewards, ads)
- Other features keep breaking when it changes
- It is live, changed by people who did not design it
- Playtests only change its tuning values

Feel and visuals stay in the prototype tier for good.

JOB STORY

When [situation], **I want to** [goal], **so I can** [outcome]. One per ticket. Criteria: happy path, guard, error.

IN EVERY PROJECT

`AGENTS.md · specs/constitution.md · STATE.md · glossary.md · open-questions.md · sources.md (existing games) · features/F001-name/ · briefs/`

Agents report; people decide. The spec keeps the reasons.

Short path: a brief. Bigger than a page? It is a feature.